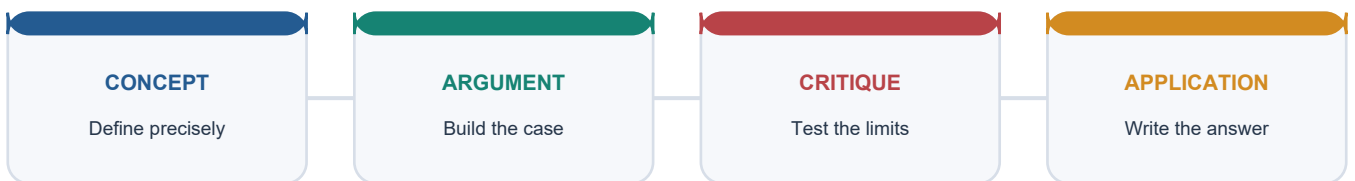


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Political Ideologies - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Political Ideologies - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

RAPID REVISION 1 - What an Ideology Is: The Discriminating Question of Domination

- Ideology = organised ideas on how society should be ordered + how to change it;
four senses: descriptive, pejorative/Marxian, integrative, action-guiding.
- Ideology is not philosophy (justified truth), political theory (concept analysis), doctrine (fixed teaching), programme (measures) or propaganda (manipulation).
- Discriminating question: cause of domination = coercive AUTHORITY (anarchism) / uncontrolled PROPERTY (socialism) / CLASS relations of the mode of production (Marxism). Diagnosis fixes the cure.
- "End of ideology" claims recur and keep being falsified by continued mobilisation; the announcement is itself ideological.
- Trap: treating the three as unrelated opinions rather than rival diagnoses of one shared target (a hierarchical, propertied, coercive order).

RAPID REVISION 2 - Anarchism I: The Case Against the State

- Anarchy (disorder) vs anarchism (normative critique of domination proposing non-coercive order) vs civil disobedience vs minimal state -- keep all four apart.
- Anti-state argument (5 steps): autonomy/equality -> state's territorial coercion monopoly -> obedience demanded for legality not rightness -> subordination of judgment -> unmet burden of justification.
- Bakunin = power corrupts ruler and ruled; Proudhon = property as institutional power of appropriation; Kropotkin = mutual aid as a real source of order.
- Presuppositions: cooperation is possible; coordination needs no sovereign centre; hierarchy intensifies conflict; existence is not legitimacy.
- Trap: reading anarchism as "people are naturally good" -- it is an institutional claim about order without a coercive superior.

RAPID REVISION 3 - Anarchism II: Strands, Voluntary Order, Objections, and Gandhi

- Strands: mutualism (Proudhon), collectivist (Bakunin), anarcho-communism (Kropotkin), individualist (markets vary; Thoreauvian resistance), philosophical (no automatic duty to obey). Sort by property + transition.
- Order emerges from reciprocity, custom, federation -- an institutional, not a psychological, claim.
- Objections: security dilemma, scale/public goods, optimistic anthropology, and HIDDEN AUTHORITY (the serious residual -- informal domination returns).
- Gandhi: anarchist AFFINITY (self-rule/swarāj, village republics, minimal state) but non-violence + trusteeship + constructive programme -> "anarchist in ideal, reformer in method".
- Trap: treating anarchism as uniformly collectivist or uniformly anti-market.

RAPID REVISION 4 - Marxism I: Method, Dialectical and Historical Materialism

- Marxism = method + critique + theory of change + political project. Say all four.
 - Six-step chain: produce -> social relations -> forces develop -> relations become fetters -> class struggle -> new mode of production.
 - Terms: productive forces (capacity); relations of production (ownership/control); mode of production (their unity); base/superstructure (relation, not switch); class struggle (motor).
 - Dialectic is materialist, not Hegelian-Idealist; "thesis-antithesis-synthesis" is NOT Marx's own formula.
 - Trap: economic determinism. Marx allows reciprocal effects; the fair criticism is a tendency to reductionism, stated before the objection is raised.
-

RAPID REVISION 5 - Marxism II: Alienation, Exploitation and Surplus Value

- Alienation (1844): from product, from the act of labour, from species-being, from other persons. Broader than low wages.
 - Species-being objection (assumes a human essence) -> minimal reconstruction (agency, recognition, control), which Althusser still rejects.
 - Surplus value: workers sell labour-power; value created > wages; the gap is appropriated; competition compels accumulation -> exploitation is structural.
 - Exploitation (relation of production) is not inequality (distribution); redistribution can leave exploitative control intact.
 - Traps: reducing Marxism to income equality; staking the answer on the contested labour theory of value instead of the structural point.
-

RAPID REVISION 6 - Marxism III: Ideology, State, Revolution, Communism, Equality

- Ideology (Marxian) = socially rooted framework making contingent class relations look natural/universal/inevitable -- "not merely a lie".
 - State (classical view) secures general capitalist conditions while claiming universality; relative autonomy is compatible with structural class function.
 - Contradiction: socialised production + private appropriation -> revolution -> dictatorship of the proletariat (transitional) -> classless, stateless communism.
 - Equality: formal / substantive / equity / freedom. Marx criticises equal legal right applied over unequal conditions.
 - Freedom is consistent with Marxism ONLY IF collective ownership enlarges self-development; bureaucratic command defeats the claim.
 - §2.9 objections: economic determinism, failed prediction, authoritarian outcome (strongest), class reductionism (necessary-but-insufficient in India).
-

RAPID REVISION 7 - Marx After Marx: Lenin, Gramsci, Althusser, Miliband and Poulantzas

- Four revisions: Lenin (imperialism, weakest link, vanguard, democratic centralism); Gramsci (hegemony, political vs civil society, organic intellectuals, war of position/manoeuvre, counter-hegemony); Althusser (RSA/ISA, interpellation, overdetermination); Miliband (1969, instrumentalism) vs Poulantzas (1973, relative autonomy, condensation of class forces).
 - One-line thesis: causal weight relocated into the superstructure; class remains the ultimate site of conflict.
 - Gramsci = terrain of contest (agency, change); Althusser = reproduction (stability, thin agency). Do not merge them.
 - State debate: Miliband instrument -> Poulantzas relative autonomy -> autonomy must stay RELATIVE or it becomes pluralism.
 - India: Part IV DPSPs (Arts 38, 39, 43) are non-justiciable illustration, never proof; characterise no actor.
-

RAPID REVISION 8 - Socialism: The Family, Its Varieties, and Gandhian Socialism

- Socialism = family subjecting productive property/economic power to social control; wider than Marxism.
 - Core argument: capacities socially inherited -> private control dominates -> markets miss need/desert -> ownership must answer to social purposes.
 - Varieties: utopian (Owen/Fourier/Saint-Simon), Marxian, Fabian/democratic, guild, market, Gandhian. Sort by ownership + method.
 - Socialism $\neq$ communism (Marxian classless higher phase) $\neq$ social democracy (private property regulated).
 - Gandhian socialism: trusteeship, bread labour, decentralisation, village self-rule (swarāj), welfare of all (sarvodaya); objection = voluntary conversion may preserve unequal ownership.
 - Traps: socialism = state ownership (it needs SOCIAL, democratic control); socialism = communism (specify phase/vocabulary).
-

RAPID REVISION 9 - Inter-School Debates: Anarchism, Marxism, Democratic Socialism, Gandhi, M. N. Roy

- Anarchism vs Marxism: authority vs class as primary domination; abolish-now vs transitional proletarian power; Bakunin's new-elite fear vs Marxist need for organised class power -- unresolved.
 - Marx vs democratic socialists: can a capitalist state be converted by ballots? Reform civilises capitalism but stalls where ownership/investment are insulated.
 - Marx vs Gandhi: class exploitation vs greed/violence/industrialism; revolution vs truth-force (satyagraha)/trusteeship; means prefigure ends for Gandhi.
 - M. N. Roy: keep the critique of exploitation, drop economic determinism and party absolutism, restore individual reason -- the Indian radical-humanist bridge.
 - Trap: declaring a winner. State both sides at their strongest and grade.
-

RAPID REVISION 10 - Criticisms, Replies and the Common Traps

- Criticism -> reply -> residual for each: anarchism (unworkable -> federation -> coercion vs persistent aggressors); Marxism (economism -> non-mechanical conditioning -> caste/gender/culture; revolution->dictatorship -> democratic agency -> adverse record); socialism (liberty -> private power also dominates -> design of accountable control; excellence -> status/capability not sameness -> scope of differential reward).
- Ten canonical traps: anarchism $\neq$ chaos; anarchists reject domination not organisation; not all anarchists collectivist; Marxism $\neq$ income equality; base->superstructure not mechanical; not Marx's "thesis-antithesis-synthesis"; socialism $\neq$ state ownership; socialism $\neq$ communism; Marx gives no blueprint; schemes/statutes are not proof of socialism.
- "Utopian" charge -> every ideology has a regulative picture; test is whether feasibility constrains normativity.

CANONICAL EXAM APPARATUS (PRESERVED VERBATIM)

The examiner apparatus below is reproduced verbatim from the canonical Political-Ideologies.md (headings demoted, navigation links stripped). It is preserved intact so that no canonical depth - the keyword and statement bank with its corpus-driven depth delta, the PYQ routing table, the answer architecture with its directive decoder, the selectable evidence bank (P1-P12) and the graded verdict formulas, the link-outs and the sources - is lost in the layered reorganisation.

Keyword and Statement Bank (with Corpus-Driven Depth Delta)

7.1 Keywords

Promoted vocabulary (this pass) ANALYSIS:: weakest link · vanguard party · democratic centralism · trade-union consciousness · substitutionism · hegemony · political society vs civil society · organic intellectuals · war of position · war of manoeuvre · counter-hegemony · contradictory consciousness · Repressive State Apparatus · Ideological State Apparatuses · interpellation · overdetermination · instrumentalism · structuralism · relative autonomy · condensation of class forces

- **Anarchism:** anti-statism · autonomy · voluntary association · mutual aid · federation · decentralisation · philosophical anarchism · domination
- **Marxism:** historical materialism · mode of production · productive forces · relations of production · class struggle · alienation · surplus value · ideology · praxis · proletarian transition
- **Socialism:** social ownership · democratic control · cooperation · need · guild socialism · market socialism · democratic socialism · trusteeship · welfare of all (*sarvodaya*)

7.2 Reusable statement lines

- FACT: Anarchism is not the absence of order but the refusal to identify order with sovereign command.
- FACT: Marxism interprets capitalism as a social relation of production, not merely an unequal distribution of income.
- ANALYSIS: The enduring Marxian insight is that formally free exchange can coexist with structurally unequal power.
- FACT: Socialism is a family of doctrines; Marxism is one revolutionary and materialist member of that family.
- ANALYSIS: Nationalisation without democratic participation may replace private domination with bureaucratic domination.
- ANALYSIS: Gandhi and Marx converge against exploitation but divide over violence, industrial scale and the moral relation of means to ends.

CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (expanded PYQ audit)

- ANALYSIS: **Priority:** Primary ownership is 13 of 112 parts; 2022 has no owned part because its Marxian equity/equality demand belongs to Ideals.

- **FACT: Required doctrinal depth:** Older papers require Gandhi as political anarchist, Marxism under free markets, pandemic/anarchism, Marxian relevance, anarchist authority and Gandhian socialism.
- **WRONG: Trap / answer consequence:** Do not use “anarchy” as mere disorder or collapse socialism into communism; state the ideology’s view of state, property, class, freedom and transition.

PYQ Routing Table (2018-2025)

ANALYSIS: Corpus signal: 13 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper II corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2018	Q2(c)	15	Do you subscribe to the political ideology of Anarchists ? Justify your answer.
2018	Q3(b)	15	Are Marxian Socialism and individual freedom consistent ? Discuss critically.
2019	Q1(c)	10	Evaluate Mahatma Gandhi as a political anarchist.
2019	Q3(c)	15	What do you consider to be the future of Marxism in the context of the prevalent free-market economy?
2020	Q1(e)	10	Do you think that the prevailing pandemic will lead to anarchism in society? Discuss.
2020	Q2(b)	15	How far is Marxism as a philosophical doctrine relevant in the present context? Justify your answer.
2021	Q3(a)	20	Discuss anarchism as a political ideology. Is it possible to dispense with political authority completely? Give reasons for your answer.
2021	Q3(b)	15	Discuss the distinctive features of Gandhian Socialism and its contemporary relevance.
2023	Q1(b)	10	Critically examine the anarchist's view that "all States always and everywhere are illegitimate and unjust."
2023	Q3(a)	20	Explain Historical Materialism and discuss its relevance in the context of social development and change.
2024	Q1(d)	10	Present an exposition of the concept of alienation as propounded by Marx.
2024	Q1(e)	10	Compare socialism and communism as two distinct political ideologies.
2025	Q2(b)	15	Evaluate Marxism as a Political Ideology.

See the Socio-Political PYQ Bank, 2018-2025.

Answer Architecture (10 / 15 / 20 Marks)

9.0 Directive decoder - the verb fixes the structure

Directive in the stem	What is actually scored	Compulsory structural move	Failure mode
Explain / Elucidate	internal logic of one doctrine	statement -> premises -> key distinction -> one example	inserting criticism at the cost of exposition
Discuss	exposition plus one adjudicated tension	doctrine -> rival -> objection -> reply -> verdict	narrating the history of a movement
Critically examine / evaluate	the objection-reply layer <i>is</i> the answer	two objections, each with reply and a residual problem	listing the failures of communist states as though that refuted a theory
Is X still relevant?	separate diagnostic power from predictive and institutional success	what the analysis still explains -> what it failed to predict -> what survives -> verdict	answering with contemporary examples instead of an argument
Compare / Distinguish	shared axes run in parallel	fix 3-4 axes, run both doctrines down each, adjudicate	two sequential doctrine summaries
Comment on a quoted line	locate the line in its doctrine before judging	source doctrine -> what it asserts -> limit -> verdict	treating the quotation as self-explanatory

9.1 10-mark method (~150 words · 4 moves · ~12 minutes)

1. **Exact doctrine (2 lines)** in technical vocabulary: *forces and relations of production, surplus value, species-being, hegemony, interpellation, relative autonomy, trusteeship, mutual aid*.
2. **Mechanism (4-5 lines)** as numbered premises - a causal chain, never a list of slogans.
3. **One evidence unit** from §9.4 with its limitation.
4. **Graded verdict (2 lines)** from §9.5.

WRONG: At 10 marks do not run the classical-to-neo trajectory. Use one doctrine or one revision, fully worked.

Worked example - alienation: define estrangement under conditions of private property and division of labour -> four dimensions (from the product, from the act of production, from species-being, from other human beings) -> the distinction from low wages, which is the mark-bearing move -> the species-being objection -> verdict on its diagnostic reach in contemporary work.

9.2 15-mark method (~220 words · 6 moves · ~18 minutes)

1. **Frame the problem** - authority, class power, property, freedom or ideology - not the topic.
2. **Doctrine** with its argument and presupposition stated.
3. **The internal rival first**, then the external one. ANALYSIS: Bringing Lenin, Gramsci, Poulantzas or Bernstein *before* the liberal critique demonstrates control of the tradition.
4. **One table:** the four revisions (§2A.1), Gramsci's two spheres (§2A.3), RSA/ISA (§2A.4) or Miliband/Poulantzas (§2A.5).
5. **One fully worked objection -> reply -> residual problem.**
6. **Conditional verdict** separating analytical survival from institutional failure.

9.3 20-mark method (~300 words · 8 moves · ~25 minutes)

1. **Provisional thesis** using the stem's own directive verb.
2. **Locate the doctrine** historically and state what turns on it.
3. **Full internal argument** in technical vocabulary.
4. **The classical -> neo trajectory** where the stem concerns Marxism: name which classical claim is revised and on what ground (§2A.1). This is the highest-yield single move available in this file.
5. **Strongest external rival** - anarchist, liberal, social-democratic or Gandhian - in its best form.
6. **Two objection -> reply chains**, each ending in a residual problem.
7. **One conceptually controlled Indian illustration**, never proof by scheme or statute.
8. **Graded verdict** separating diagnosis from prediction and from institutional record.

ANALYSIS: On "is Marxism still relevant" stems, the mark-bearing structure is a three-column judgment: what the analysis still explains (concentration, precarity, ideological reproduction, global inequality), what it failed to predict (the sequence and location of revolution, the durability of welfare compromise), and what its institutional record forecloses (the unaccountable party-state). Do not answer with a verdict on any country.

9.4 Selectable evidence bank - 1 unit at 10 marks, 2 at 15, 4-5 at 20

Each unit is **Claim -> Named anchor -> Use for -> Limitation**.

- **P1 · The state is an instrument of class rule.** Claim: political power is the organised power of one class for oppressing another; the state will wither once classes are abolished -> Named: Marx and Engels, *Manifesto of the Communist Party* -> Use for: any state-and-class stem -> Limit: contradicted by welfare and regulatory action against particular capitalists - which is what §2A.5 exists to explain.
- **P2 · History moves by the contradiction between forces and relations of production.** Claim: when productive forces outgrow existing relations, those relations become fetters and are broken -> Named: Marx's Preface to *A Contribution to the Critique of Political Economy* -> Use for: historical-materialism stems -> Limit: ANALYSIS: the base-superstructure relation is not mechanical; say so before the objection is put to you.
- **P3 · Labour is estranged in four dimensions.** Claim: from product, from productive activity, from species-being and from other persons -> Named: Marx, *Economic and Philosophic Manuscripts of 1844* -> Use for: alienation stems -> Limit: rests on a normative account of human nature that Althusser's anti-humanism explicitly rejects (P7).
- **P4 · Exploitation is structural, not a matter of unfair bargaining.** Claim: surplus value arises because labour-power's value is less than the value it creates -> Named: Marx's theory of surplus value -> Use for: exploitation and equality stems -> Limit: the labour theory of value is economically contested; argue the structural point, not the price theory.

- **P5 · Revolution breaks the chain at its weakest link, and consciousness must be brought from outside.** Claim: imperialism redistributes capitalism's contradictions globally; spontaneous struggle yields only trade-union consciousness, so a vanguard party under democratic centralism is required -> Named: Lenin (§2A.2) -> Use for: "why did revolution not occur where Marx expected" -> Limit: no mechanism reliably subordinates the party to the class - the substitutionism objection is unanswered.
- **P6 · Rule in developed societies works by consent, not chiefly by force.** Claim: hegemony is exercised through civil society - school, family, church, press, culture - by organic intellectuals, so revolution requires a war of position before a war of manoeuvre -> Named: Gramsci (§2A.3) -> Use for: ideology, culture and state stems; the most versatile unit in this file -> Limit: supplies no independent test distinguishing hegemony from ordinary agreement.
- **P7 · Subjects are produced, not presupposed.** Claim: ISAs reproduce the relations of production by interpellating individuals as subjects who freely perform the roles the structure requires; ideology is a material practice, not a mistaken belief -> Named: Althusser, RSA/ISA and interpellation (§2A.4) -> Use for: ideology and false-consciousness stems -> Limit: explains stability far better than change, and leaves a thin account of agency.
- **P8 · The capitalist state is relatively autonomous.** Claim: it must be able to act against particular capitalists in the general interest of capital, and must appear to represent "the people" to be legitimate -> Named: Poulantzas (1973), against Miliband (1969) (§2A.5) -> Use for: the internal Marxist debate on the state - the fastest route to depth -> Limit: ANALYSIS: autonomy must remain *relative*; stretched further, the analysis stops being Marxist.
- **P9 · Property is the origin of domination, and the state is its guarantor.** Claim: the state does not correct exploitation but institutionalises it, so freedom requires abolishing coercive authority, not capturing it -> Named: Proudhon, Bakunin, Kropotkin (§1) -> Use for: anarchism stems and the anarchist-Marxist dispute -> Limit: no account of large-scale coordination, external defence or enforceable rights.
- **P10 · Means determine ends.** Claim: a violent, centralising path cannot produce a non-violent, decentralised order; ownership must be reconstituted as trusteeship and wants restrained -> Named: Gandhi (§3.5, §4.3) -> Use for: the Indian foil to Marxist and anarchist strategy -> Limit: ANALYSIS: trusteeship is voluntary and depends on the goodwill of the powerful; Ambedkar's objection to reliance on the conscience of dominant groups must be stated.
- **P11 · Socialism is not communism, and neither is social democracy.** Claim: distinguish common or social ownership, the classless stateless end-state, and the parliamentary regulation of a capitalist economy -> Named: §3.4 of this file -> Use for: any definitional socialism stem -> Limit: the boundaries are historically fluid; define the sense you are using at the outset.
- **P12 · Equity is not equality.** Claim: distribution according to contribution belongs to an earlier stage; distribution according to need belongs to a later one -> Named: Marx, *Critique of the Gotha Programme* -> Use for: equity/equality stems -> Limit: a normative projection, not a demonstrated historical law.

9.5 Graded verdict formulas (adapt; never reproduce mechanically)

- **Diagnosis/remedy split:** "The analysis of <concentration, exploitation, ideological reproduction> retains force; the institutional remedy - an unaccountable transitional state - does not, and the theory supplies no internal safeguard against it."
- **Relocation verdict:** "Neo-Marxism does not abandon the materialist mechanism; it relocates causal weight into party, culture, state form and subject-formation - so the tradition is refined rather than refuted."
- **Necessary-not-sufficient verdict:** "Class analysis is necessary but insufficient in the Indian context: caste and gender operate through mechanisms of status, endogamy and social reproduction that cannot be derived from class alone."
- **Bounded-autonomy verdict:** "The capitalist state must be granted autonomy to explain what it actually does, and denied unlimited autonomy to remain a Marxist state at all; the theory lives precisely in that boundary."
- **Means-ends verdict:** "Where the means constitute the end, a doctrine that postpones liberty to secure equality cannot deliver the freedom it promises."
- **Asymmetric verdict:** "<Doctrine>'s critique of existing arrangements is stronger than its account of the arrangements that should replace them."

Link-Outs to Related Topics

- Social and Political Ideals - formal/substantive equality, liberty and Marxian equity.
- Individual and State - anarchist and Marxist critiques of authority and rights.
- Forms of Government - democracy, participation and the danger of concentrated rule.
- Development and Social Progress - socialist, Marxian and Gandhian models of progress.
- Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar - why class analysis alone is insufficient in India.
- Hegel - dialectic and Marx's materialist transformation.
- Religion without God - Marx, humanism and secular critiques of religion.
- Philosophy in other answers - controlled deployment in GS and Essay.

Sources

- Local course source, *Socio-Political Philosophy*, sections on anarchism, Marxism, socialism and M. N. Roy.
- O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, chapters on ideology, socialism, Marxism, anarchism and Gandhism.
- Karl Marx, *Economic and Philosophic Manuscripts of 1844; A Contribution to the Critique of Political Economy* (Preface); *Critique of the Gotha Programme*; and, with Friedrich Engels, *Manifesto of the Communist Party*.
- Pierre-Joseph Proudhon, *What Is Property?*
- Mikhail Bakunin, *Statism and Anarchy*.
- Peter Kropotkin, *Mutual Aid* and *The Conquest of Bread*.
- M. K. Gandhi, *Hind Swaraj* and writings on trusteeship, self-rule (*swarāj*) and the welfare of all (*sarvodaya*).
- M. N. Roy, writings on Radical Humanism.
- V. I. Lenin, *Imperialism, the Highest Stage of Capitalism* and *What Is To Be Done?* - the weakest-link and vanguard-party arguments. Cited by title only; paraphrased, never quoted.
- Antonio Gramsci, *Prison Notebooks* - hegemony, political and civil society, organic intellectuals, war of position. Cited by title only; paraphrased, never quoted.
- Louis Althusser, "Ideology and Ideological State Apparatuses" - RSA/ISA and interpellation. Cited by title only; paraphrased, never quoted.
- Ralph Miliband, *The State in Capitalist Society* (1969) - the instrumentalist thesis.
- Nicos Poulantzas, *Political Power and Social Classes* (1973) - relative autonomy and the state as a condensation of class forces.
- The Constitution of India - Legislative Department, Part IV Directive Principles, used only as a dated constitutional illustration; these are non-justiciable.

ANALYSIS: **Provenance note for §2A (added in this pass):** the Lenin, Gramsci, Althusser and Miliband-Poulantzas modules are named-scholar reconstructions adapted into this Philosophy owner. No page, chapter, edition or verbatim wording is asserted for any of them, and no empirical claim is made about any country, party, government, period or class - Indian or otherwise. Doctrines deliberately **not** developed here, to preserve single ownership, are listed at §2A.7.

ORIGINAL MCQ MASTERY SET - EXACTLY 48 QUESTIONS

Questions 1-40 are core coverage - four per subtopic across the ten subtopics; Questions 41-48 are remedial items targeting the most common misreadings. Correct answers rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D 12 times.

MCQ 1

The single question that most efficiently sorts anarchism, socialism and Marxism is:

A. what is the deepest cause of domination -- coercive authority, uncontrolled property, or the capitalist mode of production B. which ideology is the oldest historically C. which ideology has the largest number of followers today D. whether the ideology originated in Europe or in Asia

Correct answer: A - what is the deepest cause of domination -- coercive authority, uncontrolled property, or the capitalist mode of production

Explanation: The canonical 'discriminating question' identifies the diagnosed cause of domination (authority / property / mode of production), which then fixes the cure.

MCQ 2

The 'pejorative' or Marxian sense of the word ideology refers to:

A. any organised belief-system that guides political action B. a socially rooted framework that makes historically specific, class-bound relations appear natural, universal or inevitable C. a fixed authoritative teaching handed down by a party D. a concrete list of policy measures for an election

Correct answer: B - a socially rooted framework that makes historically specific, class-bound relations appear natural, universal or inevitable

Explanation: In the Marxian critique (canonical 2.6), ideology is 'not merely a lie' but a framework naturalising contingent relations -- distinct from the neutral, descriptive sense.

MCQ 3

Ideology is distinguished from PROPAGANDA principally because:

A. ideology is always false while propaganda is always true B. propaganda contains a theory of history while ideology does not C. ideology offers a diagnosis and a picture of the good order, whereas propaganda is manipulative persuasion indifferent to truth D. the two are exact synonyms in political theory

Correct answer: C - ideology offers a diagnosis and a picture of the good order, whereas propaganda is manipulative persuasion indifferent to truth

Explanation: Ideology (diagnosis + picture of the good order + strategy) differs from propaganda (manipulation indifferent to truth), and from philosophy, doctrine and programme.

MCQ 4

The 'end of ideology' thesis is best assessed as:

A. a proven fact after 1991 B. a description that applies only to anarchism C. a claim confined to economic policy D. an empirically weak claim, since continued anarchist, Marxist, nationalist and ecological mobilisation persists, and the announcement is itself an ideological move

Correct answer: D - an empirically weak claim, since continued anarchist, Marxist, nationalist and ecological mobilisation persists, and the announcement is itself an ideological move

Explanation: The persistence of ideological mobilisation falsifies the 'end of ideology'; declaring ideology finished is itself an ideological gesture.

MCQ 5

The distinction between 'anarchy' and 'anarchism' is that:

A. anarchy is the absence or collapse of effective rule (possibly disorder), while anarchism is a normative critique of domination that proposes non-coercive order B. anarchy is a normative doctrine while anarchism means chaos C. the two terms are interchangeable D. anarchy refers to socialism and anarchism to communism

Correct answer: A - anarchy is the absence or collapse of effective rule (possibly disorder), while anarchism is a normative critique of domination that proposes non-coercive order

Explanation: Conflating anarchy (disorder) with anarchism (a considered doctrine of order without a sovereign centre) is the canonical trap.

MCQ 6

The core of the anarchist argument against the state is that:

A. the state is simply too large to administer efficiently B. the state demands obedience because a command is legally authoritative rather than independently right, thereby subordinating one person's judgment to another's institutional will C. the state cannot collect enough taxes to function D. monarchy is preferable to a republic

Correct answer: B - the state demands obedience because a command is legally authoritative rather than independently right, thereby subordinating one person's judgment to another's institutional will

Explanation: The burden-of-justification argument turns on obedience being owed to legality, not rightness -- an unmet burden the state cannot discharge.

MCQ 7

Which pairing of anarchist thinker and emphasis is correct?

A. Kropotkin -- property is theft as an institutional power B. Proudhon -- concentrated power corrupts both ruler and ruled C. Bakunin -- concentrated power deforms ruler and ruled (the corruption thesis) D. Bakunin -- mutual aid as the primary source of social order

Correct answer: C - Bakunin -- concentrated power deforms ruler and ruled (the corruption thesis)

Explanation: Bakunin supplies the corruption thesis; Proudhon targets property-as-appropriation; Kropotkin supplies mutual aid -- so only the Bakunin-corruption pairing is right.

MCQ 8

A key PRESUPPOSITION of anarchism, correctly stated, is that:

A. human beings are always benevolent and never selfish B. social coordination logically requires a single sovereign centre C. historical existence by itself establishes an institution's moral legitimacy D. coordination does not logically require a sovereign centre, since federations and associations can perform many coordinating functions

Correct answer: D - coordination does not logically require a sovereign centre, since federations and associations can perform many coordinating functions

Explanation: Anarchism's claim is institutional, not a naive psychology: coordination can occur through federation without a final coercive superior.

MCQ 9

Anarcho-communism (Kropotkin) is distinguished from mutualism (Proudhon) chiefly by:

A. favouring common ownership with distribution according to need, rather than possession and exchange without exploitative property B. supporting a strong centralised state C. rejecting all forms of cooperation D. endorsing hereditary monarchy

Correct answer: A - favouring common ownership with distribution according to need, rather than possession and exchange without exploitative property

Explanation: Anarcho-communism = common ownership + distribution by need (communes, mutual aid); mutualism = possession and exchange through contracts and associations.

MCQ 10

The STRONGEST internal objection to anarchism, which a defensible anarchism must concede, is:

A. that anarchists dislike all cooperation B. the 'hidden authority' problem -- expertise, informal status and economic power return even after the state is abolished C. that anarchism has no named thinkers D. that anarchism requires a hereditary ruler

Correct answer: B - the 'hidden authority' problem -- expertise, informal status and economic power return even after the state is abolished

Explanation: Security and scale objections have replies; the hidden-authority objection is the serious residual, demanding scrutiny of domination inside voluntary associations.

MCQ 11

The safest exam formulation of Gandhi's relation to anarchism is that he is:

A. a full Bakuninite revolutionary anarchist B. in no sense connected to anarchism C. a moral and decentralist anarchist in ideal, but a pragmatic reformer in political method D. an advocate of a strong centralised industrial state

Correct answer: C - a moral and decentralist anarchist in ideal, but a pragmatic reformer in political method

Explanation: Gandhi's self-rule (swaraj) and minimal-state decentralism give an anarchist affinity, but non-violence, trusteeship and constructive work make him a reformer in method.

MCQ 12

Philosophical anarchism is best characterised as the view that:

A. every state must be overthrown by immediate insurrection B. anarchism requires collective ownership of all property C. anarchism is identical with civil disobedience D. there is no automatic duty to obey the state, though critical allegiance to institutions may coexist with the critique

Correct answer: D - there is no automatic duty to obey the state, though critical allegiance to institutions may coexist with the critique

Explanation: Philosophical anarchism denies an automatic duty to obey without demanding insurrection -- the discriminating reply to the 'all states are unjust' stem.

MCQ 13

In Marx's causal chain, social and political struggle arises when:

- A. the developing productive forces come into conflict with existing relations of production, which become fetters
- B. rulers simply become morally corrupt
- C. the population grows beyond available land
- D. citizens lose religious faith

Correct answer: A - the developing productive forces come into conflict with existing relations of production, which become fetters

Explanation: Historical materialism locates the motor in the contradiction between developing forces and existing relations of production, not in moral or demographic factors.

MCQ 14

The correct UPSC-safe statement of the base-superstructure relation is that it is:

- A. a mechanical one-way cause from economy to every idea
- B. a relation in which base and superstructure interact reciprocally, so the fair criticism is a TENDENCY toward reductionism, not a crude determinism Marx never qualified
- C. a claim that ideas determine the economy
- D. irrelevant to Marxist theory

Correct answer: B - a relation in which base and superstructure interact reciprocally, so the fair criticism is a TENDENCY toward reductionism, not a crude determinism Marx never qualified

Explanation: Marx allows reciprocal effects and political agency; the legitimate criticism is a tendency to economic reductionism, stated before the objection is raised.

MCQ 15

Presenting 'thesis-antithesis-synthesis' as Marx's own fixed three-step law is:

- A. an accurate summary of Capital
- B. the central claim of historical materialism
- C. a common error, since that formula is a later textbook shorthand and not Marx's own fixed law
- D. a phrase coined by Kropotkin

Correct answer: C - a common error, since that formula is a later textbook shorthand and not Marx's own fixed law

Explanation: The triad is a later shorthand; asserting it as Marx's formula signals a second-hand reading -- a canonical trap.

MCQ 16

'Relations of production' in historical materialism refers to:

- A. the tools and technology available to a society
- B. the total population engaged in farming
- C. the level of scientific knowledge
- D. the ownership, control and class relations that determine who commands and appropriates

Correct answer: D - the ownership, control and class relations that determine who commands and appropriates

Explanation: Relations of production = ownership/control and class relations; productive forces are the capacity to produce; their unity is the mode of production.

MCQ 17

Marx's four dimensions of alienation are estrangement from:

A. the product, the activity of labour, species-being, and other persons B. the state, the church, the family, and the market C. land, labour, capital, and enterprise D. reason, emotion, will, and memory

Correct answer: A - the product, the activity of labour, species-being, and other persons

Explanation: The 1844 Manuscripts identify estrangement from product, from the act of labour, from species-being, and from other persons.

MCQ 18

A crucial feature of Marx's concept of alienation is that:

A. it applies only to unemployed workers B. it is broader than low wages, since a well-paid worker can remain alienated where labour, product and purpose are controlled by others C. it disappears once the minimum wage is raised D. it is identical to legal inequality

Correct answer: B - it is broader than low wages, since a well-paid worker can remain alienated where labour, product and purpose are controlled by others

Explanation: Alienation concerns control over the activity and ends of work, so higher pay alone does not remove it -- the mark-bearing distinction.

MCQ 19

According to Marx, surplus value arises because:

A. capitalists steal wages outright through fraud B. workers are paid more than the value they create C. the value produced during the working day can exceed the value represented by wages, and the remainder is appropriated by owners of capital D. the state taxes workers too heavily

Correct answer: C - the value produced during the working day can exceed the value represented by wages, and the remainder is appropriated by owners of capital

Explanation: Exploitation is structural, not theft: under a formally free contract the labour done can create more value than the wage returns, and that gap is appropriated.

MCQ 20

The distinction between exploitation and inequality, for Marx, is that:

A. they are the same thing B. inequality concerns the relation of production while exploitation concerns distribution C. exploitation can only occur in feudalism D. exploitation concerns the social RELATION of production (control and appropriation), while inequality concerns the DISTRIBUTION of holdings, so redistribution can leave exploitative control intact

Correct answer: D - exploitation concerns the social RELATION of production (control and appropriation), while inequality concerns the DISTRIBUTION of holdings, so redistribution can leave exploitative control intact

Explanation: Because exploitation is about control and appropriation, a welfare transfer that reduces inequality need not touch the exploitative relation.

MCQ 21

For Marx, the 'dictatorship of the proletariat' denotes:

- A. a transitional political supremacy of the working class, not in itself a textual licence for permanent one-party dictatorship
- B. the permanent rule of a single vanguard party
- C. rule by a hereditary monarch advised by workers
- D. the immediate and final abolition of all authority

Correct answer: A - a transitional political supremacy of the working class, not in itself a textual licence for permanent one-party dictatorship

Explanation: The phrase names a transitional class supremacy; reading it as a warrant for a permanent party-state is a canonical overreach.

MCQ 22

In the Marxist critique, ideology is best defined as:

- A. simply a deliberate lie told by rulers
- B. a socially rooted framework through which historically specific relations appear natural, universal or inevitable
- C. any scientific theory of economics
- D. the constitution of a state

Correct answer: B - a socially rooted framework through which historically specific relations appear natural, universal or inevitable

Explanation: Ideology is 'not merely a lie' but the naturalisation of contingent, class-bound relations -- the pejorative Marxian sense.

MCQ 23

Marx's critique of 'equal legal right' is that:

- A. all legal rights should be abolished immediately
- B. formal equality is always sufficient for justice
- C. formally identical rules operating over radically unequal social conditions can conceal unequal productive power, so formal equality may mask domination
- D. equity and equality mean exactly the same thing

Correct answer: C - formally identical rules operating over radically unequal social conditions can conceal unequal productive power, so formal equality may mask domination

Explanation: Marx distinguishes formal from substantive equality: the same rule applied to unequal conditions can entrench, not remove, domination.

MCQ 24

Marxian socialism and individual freedom are consistent, according to the canonical file, only if:

- A. the individual is fully subordinated to the party
- B. private property is expanded
- C. the state is abolished overnight
- D. collective ownership genuinely enlarges real self-development and democratic control, rather than becoming bureaucratic command

Correct answer: D - collective ownership genuinely enlarges real self-development and democratic control, rather than becoming bureaucratic command

Explanation: The self-defeat condition: emancipation requires that collective power expand freedom; bureaucratic command defeats the emancipatory claim.

MCQ 25

Lenin's revision of classical Marxism holds that:

- A. the imperialist chain breaks at its weakest link, and revolutionary consciousness must be brought from outside by a vanguard party under democratic centralism
- B. revolution must occur only in the most industrially advanced economy
- C. spontaneous worker struggle automatically produces revolutionary consciousness
- D. the state should be strengthened permanently

Correct answer: A - the imperialist chain breaks at its weakest link, and revolutionary consciousness must be brought from outside by a vanguard party under democratic centralism

Explanation: Lenin relocates revolution to the weakest link and argues spontaneous struggle yields only trade-union consciousness, so a vanguard party is needed.

MCQ 26

Gramsci's concept of hegemony refers to:

- A. rule maintained purely by police and army
- B. moral, intellectual and cultural leadership securing the CONSENT of the subordinated through civil society (school, church, press, culture)
- C. the economic base determining ideas mechanically
- D. the abolition of all intellectuals

Correct answer: B - moral, intellectual and cultural leadership securing the CONSENT of the subordinated through civil society (school, church, press, culture)

Explanation: Hegemony is consent won and lost in civil society by organic intellectuals -- the first substantial concession of relative autonomy to the superstructure.

MCQ 27

Althusser's concept of interpellation describes how:

- A. the state uses only violence to rule
- B. the economy directly produces all laws
- C. ideology 'hails' individuals as subjects, so that in recognising themselves in assigned roles they are constituted as subjects who freely do what the structure requires
- D. workers spontaneously develop revolutionary consciousness

Correct answer: C - ideology 'hails' individuals as subjects, so that in recognising themselves in assigned roles they are constituted as subjects who freely do what the structure requires

Explanation: For Althusser ideology is a material practice; ISAs reproduce relations of production by interpellating individuals as subjects -- explaining stability better than change.

MCQ 28

In the Miliband-Poulantzas debate, Poulantzas argues that the capitalist state has:

A. no autonomy whatsoever from individual capitalists B. complete and unlimited autonomy from all class forces C. authority derived solely from divine right D. relative autonomy from any particular fraction of capital, enabling it to act for capital-in-general and appear to represent 'the people', so long as that autonomy remains RELATIVE

Correct answer: D - relative autonomy from any particular fraction of capital, enabling it to act for capital-in-general and appear to represent 'the people', so long as that autonomy remains RELATIVE

Explanation: Poulantzas answers Miliband's instrumentalism with relative autonomy; stretched past 'relative', the analysis stops being Marxist and becomes pluralism.

MCQ 29

The relationship between socialism and Marxism is best stated as:

A. socialism is a family of doctrines subjecting productive property to social control, of which Marxism is one revolutionary and materialist member B. socialism and Marxism are identical C. Marxism is broader than socialism D. socialism rejects all social control of property

Correct answer: A - socialism is a family of doctrines subjecting productive property to social control, of which Marxism is one revolutionary and materialist member

Explanation: Socialism names the whole family (utopian, Marxian, Fabian, guild, market, Gandhian); Marxism is one member of it.

MCQ 30

Which correctly distinguishes socialism, communism and social democracy?

A. all three abolish the state immediately B. socialism = social control in varied forms; communism (Marxian higher phase) = common ownership with classes abolished and distribution by need; social democracy = private property retained but regulated with tax-transfer C. communism retains private property while social democracy abolishes it D. social democracy is the revolutionary transition to communism

Correct answer: B - socialism = social control in varied forms; communism (Marxian higher phase) = common ownership with classes abolished and distribution by need; social democracy = private property retained but regulated with tax-transfer

Explanation: The axes property/state/distribution/method separate the family (socialism), the classless end-state (communism) and the regulated-capitalism route (social democracy).

MCQ 31

A distinctive feature of Gandhian socialism is:

A. violent seizure of the means of production B. centralised heavy industrialisation C. trusteeship, bread labour, decentralised production and the welfare of all (sarvodaya), seeking equality without class war or centralist collectivism D. unrestricted free-market capitalism

Correct answer: C - trusteeship, bread labour, decentralised production and the welfare of all (sarvodaya), seeking equality without class war or centralist collectivism

Explanation: Gandhian socialism combines non-possession, trusteeship, decentralisation and village self-rule (swaraj), rejecting both unrestricted capitalism and violent centralised collectivism.

MCQ 32

The canonical warning that 'socialism is not identical with state ownership' means that:

A. socialism requires the monarchy to own all land B. socialism forbids any public sector C. communism and socialism are the same D. socialisation requires control by SOCIETY -- democratic, participatory, accountable -- since nationalisation alone can become ownership by officials (bureaucratic domination)

Correct answer: D - socialisation requires control by SOCIETY -- democratic, participatory, accountable -- since nationalisation alone can become ownership by officials (bureaucratic domination)

Explanation: Nationalisation without democratic control merely replaces private domination with bureaucratic domination; socialisation means accountable social control.

MCQ 33

The central disagreement between anarchism and Marxism concerns:

A. the state: anarchism would abolish it without a transitional sovereign, while Marxism uses transitional proletarian political power before it withers B. whether capitalism should be retained C. whether human beings can cooperate D. whether religion should be established

Correct answer: A - the state: anarchism would abolish it without a transitional sovereign, while Marxism uses transitional proletarian political power before it withers

Explanation: Both target capitalism, but split on the state: immediate abolition (anarchism) vs transitional class power (Marxism) -- the core of the 'dispense with authority' stem.

MCQ 34

Bakunin's prediction against the Marxist transition is that:

A. capitalism will collapse of its own accord without struggle B. a revolutionary workers' state may itself create a new ruling stratum, becoming a new despotism C. the peasantry can never be revolutionary D. religion will disappear automatically

Correct answer: B - a revolutionary workers' state may itself create a new ruling stratum, becoming a new despotism

Explanation: Bakunin warns the transitional state breeds a new elite -- the anarchist objection Marxists answer by insisting organised class power is needed to defeat entrenched property.

MCQ 35

The core contrast between Marx and Gandhi includes that:

A. both endorse violent revolution B. both reject decentralisation C. Marx locates the root in class exploitation and accepts revolutionary transition, while Gandhi locates it in greed, violence and modern industrialism and insists means must prefigure ends D. Gandhi supports large-scale centralised production

Correct answer: C - Marx locates the root in class exploitation and accepts revolutionary transition, while Gandhi locates it in greed, violence and modern industrialism and insists means must prefigure ends

Explanation: Marx vs Gandhi divides on violence, industrial scale and the means-ends relation, though both oppose exploitation.

MCQ 36

M. N. Roy's radical-humanist criticism of Marxism proposes to:

A. subordinate the individual entirely to the party B. abandon the critique of exploitation altogether C. restore hereditary authority D. retain Marx's critique of exploitation while rejecting economic determinism and party absolutism and restoring individual reason and ethical autonomy

Correct answer: D - retain Marx's critique of exploitation while rejecting economic determinism and party absolutism and restoring individual reason and ethical autonomy

Explanation: Roy is the internal Indian bridge: keep the exploitation critique, drop determinism and party absolutism, recover individual freedom.

MCQ 37

For the objection 'revolution produces dictatorship', the canonical reply-and-residual pairing is:

A. reply: emancipation requires democratic proletarian agency; residual: the historical record of transitional states remains adverse B. reply: dictatorship is always good; residual: none C. reply: revolution is impossible; residual: capitalism is eternal D. reply: monarchy is preferable; residual: none

Correct answer: A - reply: emancipation requires democratic proletarian agency; residual: the historical record of transitional states remains adverse

Explanation: The strongest reply invokes democratic proletarian agency, but the adverse historical record is the honest residual that a graded answer must state.

MCQ 38

Which is a canonical UPSC trap to AVOID?

A. stating that anarchism proposes order without sovereign coercion B. identifying socialism with state ownership, when socialisation actually requires control by society rather than merely by officials C. distinguishing exploitation from inequality D. reading base-superstructure as reciprocal

Correct answer: B - identifying socialism with state ownership, when socialisation actually requires control by society rather than merely by officials

Explanation: Equating socialism with state ownership is a listed trap; socialisation means accountable social control, not ownership by officials.

MCQ 39

The disciplined reply to the all-purpose charge that an ideology is 'utopian' is that:

A. all ideologies should be abandoned as impractical B. only Marxism is utopian C. every ideology contains a regulative picture of a justified order, so the real test is whether feasibility CONSTRAINS rather than replaces the normative claim D. utopianism is always a fatal objection

Correct answer: C - every ideology contains a regulative picture of a justified order, so the real test is whether feasibility CONSTRAINS rather than replaces the normative claim

Explanation: Since every ideology (including liberalism) has a regulative ideal, the test is whether feasibility constrains normativity, not whether an ideal exists.

MCQ 40

Treating a welfare scheme, cooperative or statute as PROOF that socialism is true or false is:

A. the correct method for evaluating ideologies B. required by historical materialism C. the way Marx settled the question D. a canonical error, since these are dated institutional illustrations while the philosophical issue is control, freedom and justice

Correct answer: D - a canonical error, since these are dated institutional illustrations while the philosophical issue is control, freedom and justice

Explanation: Statutes and schemes illustrate what a state has enacted; they cannot settle a philosophical question about control, freedom and justice.

Remedial MCQ 41

Remedial -- a candidate writes 'a pandemic will cause anarchism'. The correct correction is that:

A. a crisis may cause temporary ANARCHY (disorder) or a surge of voluntary mutual aid, but not anarchISM, which is a normative doctrine of order without sovereign coercion B. a pandemic always establishes anarchism permanently C. anarchy and anarchism mean the same thing D. anarchism means the collapse of all cooperation

Correct answer: A - a crisis may cause temporary ANARCHY (disorder) or a surge of voluntary mutual aid, but not anarchISM, which is a normative doctrine of order without sovereign coercion

Explanation: Anarchy (disorder) must not be confused with anarchism (a considered doctrine); crises typically strengthen demands for competent public authority.

Remedial MCQ 42

Remedial -- 'Marx's method is the thesis-antithesis-synthesis law'. The correct correction is that:

A. this is the central formula of Capital B. the triad is a later textbook shorthand, not Marx's own fixed three-step law; Marx's dialectic is materialist, locating contradiction in social life C. Marx borrowed it unchanged from Kropotkin D. the triad proves economic determinism

Correct answer: B - the triad is a later textbook shorthand, not Marx's own fixed three-step law; Marx's dialectic is materialist, locating contradiction in social life

Explanation: Attributing 'thesis-antithesis-synthesis' to Marx as a fixed law is a canonical trap; his dialectic is materialist and non-mechanical.

Remedial MCQ 43

Remedial -- 'socialism and communism are synonyms'. The correct correction is that:

A. they are indeed identical in every school B. communism is broader than socialism C. socialism names the whole family that socialises economic power by diverse routes, while communism (Marxian) names a specific classless, stateless, need-based end-state -- so specify vocabulary and phase D. social democracy is the same as communism

Correct answer: C - socialism names the whole family that socialises economic power by diverse routes, while communism (Marxian) names a specific classless, stateless, need-based end-state -- so specify vocabulary and phase

Explanation: In Marxist usage socialism often denotes the transitional lower phase; in wider theory it names the family. Never treat the two as loose synonyms.

Remedial MCQ 44

Remedial -- 'Marxism is basically the demand for equal incomes'. The correct correction is that:

A. Marxism is only about wages B. Marxism demands identical incomes for all C. equality of income is Marx's central category D. Marxism's central categories are production, class, exploitation, alienation and praxis -- not equality of income; it criticises the wage-relation, not merely unequal pay

Correct answer: D - Marxism's central categories are production, class, exploitation, alienation and praxis -- not equality of income; it criticises the wage-relation, not merely unequal pay

Explanation: Reducing Marxism to income equality misses its structural categories; exploitation concerns control and appropriation, not distribution alone.

Remedial MCQ 45

Remedial -- 'the economic base mechanically determines every idea'. The correct correction is that:

A. base and superstructure interact reciprocally, and Marx allows political agency; the fair criticism is a tendency to reductionism, not a determinism he never qualified B. ideas alone determine the economy C. the superstructure has no causal weight at all D. the base-superstructure relation is irrelevant to Marxism

Correct answer: A - base and superstructure interact reciprocally, and Marx allows political agency; the fair criticism is a tendency to reductionism, not a determinism he never qualified

Explanation: The base-superstructure relation is reciprocal, not a one-way switch; economic reductionism is a tendency to guard against, not a doctrine Marx asserted crudely.

Remedial MCQ 46

Remedial -- 'Gandhi was simply a Bakuninite anarchist'. The correct correction is that:

A. Gandhi wanted a strong centralised industrial state B. Gandhi is a moral and decentralist anarchist in IDEAL but a pragmatic reformer in METHOD, replacing class war and anti-theism with non-violence, trusteeship and constructive work C. Gandhi rejected self-rule (swaraj) and decentralisation D. Gandhi endorsed violent insurrection against the state

Correct answer: B - Gandhi is a moral and decentralist anarchist in IDEAL but a pragmatic reformer in METHOD, replacing class war and anti-theism with non-violence, trusteeship and constructive work

Explanation: Gandhi shares an anarchist affinity (decentralised self-rule/swaraj, minimal state) but diverges on non-violence and method -- 'anarchist in ideal, reformer in method'.

Remedial MCQ 47

Remedial -- 'the capitalist state is completely autonomous from class power'. The correct correction is that:

A. the state has no autonomy at all B. the state's authority is charismatic C. for Poulantzas the state has RELATIVE autonomy that is functional for capital; stretched into COMPLETE autonomy, the analysis ceases to be Marxist and becomes pluralism D. the state is an instrument with no independent action

Correct answer: C - for Poulantzas the state has RELATIVE autonomy that is functional for capital; stretched into COMPLETE autonomy, the analysis ceases to be Marxist and becomes pluralism

Explanation: Autonomy must remain relative; 'complete' autonomy from class power collapses the Marxist analysis into the pluralist state under another name.

Remedial MCQ 48

Remedial -- 'Marx gives a detailed blueprint of communist institutions'. The correct correction is that:

A. Marx wrote a full constitution for communism B. Marx specified the exact economic plan of the higher phase C. Marx described communist courts and parties in detail D. Marx's account of communism is deliberately limited; he offers no detailed institutional blueprint, distribution 'according to need' being a projected higher-phase principle, not a plan

Correct answer: D - Marx's account of communism is deliberately limited; he offers no detailed institutional blueprint, distribution 'according to need' being a projected higher-phase principle, not a plan

Explanation: Claiming Marx blueprints communist institutions is a canonical error; his account is deliberately sparse, which is why later regimes cannot be read back into him.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

EXAM APPLICATION 1 - What an Ideology Is: The Discriminating Question of Domination

This subtopic is the FRAME every Political-Ideologies stem opens with -- the two lines of concept-mapping the 15/20-mark method (§9.2-9.3) demands before doctrine.

- Any ideology stem should begin by NAMING the diagnosis axis (authority vs property vs mode of production) and, where the verb is "evaluate as an ideology" (2025 Marxism), by separating the descriptive sense (a political ideology) from the pejorative sense (the critique of ideology) at the outset.
- **Ownership caution:** the 2018 Q1(a) "liberal democracy" stem uses ideology vocabulary but is owned by Forms of Government; the 2022 Q2(c) "equity vs equality with reference to Marxian philosophy" stem is owned by Social and Political Ideals, which is why this clause has NO owned part in 2022. Deploy the frame; do not claim those questions.

MEMORY: Concept spine -> which SENSE of ideology is in play -> which DIAGNOSIS of domination (authority / property / mode of production) -> only then expound the specific doctrine.

EXAM APPLICATION 2 - Anarchism I: The Case Against the State

This is the doctrinal core behind every anarchism stem (2018 Q2c, 2021 Q3a, 2023 Q1b, and the applied 2019/2020 stems).

- **2023 Q1(b)** ("all States always and everywhere are illegitimate and unjust") is exactly the five-step argument, pushed to its strongest universal form: run premises (1)-(5), then test the word "always/everywhere" -- philosophical anarchism (§1.4) denies an automatic duty to obey without asserting that every state is maximally unjust, which is the discriminating reply.
- **2021 Q3(a)** ("dispense with political authority completely?") demands the argument PLUS the objections layer (next subtopic): state the case, then decide how far it can be pushed.

MEMORY: 10-mark anarchism = burden-of-justification argument in four moves + one named anchor (Bakunin corruption / Proudhon property / Kropotkin mutual aid) + a graded verdict; do not narrate a movement's history.

EXAM APPLICATION 3 - Anarchism II: Strands, Voluntary Order, Objections, and Gandhi

This subtopic owns the strand-and-objection material behind the anarchism stems and the Gandhi-as-anarchist stem.

- **2019 Q1(c)** ("Evaluate Mahatma Gandhi as a political anarchist") is answered precisely by the IDEAL-vs-METHOD formulation: affinity (decentralised self-rule/swarāj, minimal state) then divergence (non-violence, trusteeship, constructive programme), then a verdict that he is a moral/decentralist anarchist in ideal, a reformer in method.
- **2023 Q1(b) / 2021 Q3(a)** need the objection ladder; lead with HIDDEN AUTHORITY as the residual problem to show command.
- **Ownership caution:** caste-specific Gandhi/Ambedkar stems are owned by Caste; Thoreau/civil-disobedience as an obligation family is owned by Individual and State. Name Gandhi's anarchist affinity here; route the caste debate away.

MEMORY: Gandhi = anarchist in ideal, reformer in method. Objection ladder = security / scale / anthropology / HIDDEN AUTHORITY (the residual).

EXAM APPLICATION 4 - Marxism I: Method, Dialectical and Historical Materialism

This subtopic is the doctrinal base for the historical-materialism and "relevance of Marxism" stems.

- **2023 Q3(a)** ("Explain Historical Materialism and discuss its relevance") is a

20-marker: run the six-step chain as numbered premises (not slogans), state the base-superstructure nuance, then split relevance into what it still explains (concentration, precarity, ideological reproduction, global inequality) vs what it failed to predict (the sequence/location of revolution).

- **2020 Q2(b) / 2019 Q3(c)** ("relevance / future of Marxism under free markets")

reuse the same diagnosis-vs-prediction split; never answer with a verdict on any country.

MEMORY: Historical materialism = the six-step chain in premises + the reciprocal base/superstructure caution. Relevance stems = three columns: what it still explains / what it failed to predict / what its institutional record forecloses.

EXAM APPLICATION 5 - Marxism II: Alienation, Exploitation and Surplus Value

This subtopic owns the alienation stem outright and feeds every Marxism-as-critique answer.

- **2024 Q1(d)** ("Present an exposition of the concept of alienation as

propounded by Marx") is a pure 10-mark exposition: define estrangement under private property and division of labour -> the four dimensions -> the distinction from low wages (the mark-bearing move) -> the species-being objection -> a verdict on its diagnostic reach in contemporary work. Directive is "Present an exposition", so do NOT crowd it with criticism at the cost of clear exposition.

- **2025 Q2(b) / 2020 Q2(b)** on Marxism-as-ideology / relevance draw the exploitation-vs-inequality distinction as their sharpest single unit.

MEMORY: Alienation 10-marker = definition + four dimensions + "broader than low wages" + species-being objection + verdict. Keep exposition dominant when the verb is "expound/present".

EXAM APPLICATION 6 - Marxism III: Ideology, State, Revolution, Communism, Equality

This subtopic carries the "Marxian socialism and freedom" and "Marxism-as-ideology" stems.

- **2018 Q3(b)** ("Are Marxian Socialism and individual freedom consistent?") is

answered by the conditional: consistent IF collective ownership enlarges self-development and democratic control; self-defeating IF it becomes bureaucratic command. Run objection (bureaucratic domination) -> reply (democratic control, accountability) -> residual (the historical record).

- **2025 Q2(b)** ("Evaluate Marxism as a Political Ideology") uses the four objections of §2.9 (economic determinism, failed prediction, authoritarian outcome, class reductionism), each with reply and residual, then a diagnosis-vs- remedy verdict.

- **Ownership caution:** the 2022 Q2(c) equity-vs-equality-with-Marx stem is owned by Social and Political Ideals; deploy the four equality senses here but do not claim that question.

MEMORY: Freedom-consistency = the "only if... otherwise self-defeats" conditional. Marxism-as-ideology = the four §2.9 objections, each graded, + diagnosis/remedy split.

EXAM APPLICATION 7 - Marx After Marx: Lenin, Gramsci, Althusser, Miliband and Poulantzas

This subtopic is the single highest-yield depth reserve for the Marxism stems.

- **2025 Q2(b) / 2020 Q2(b) / 2019 Q3(c)** ("evaluate / relevance / future of Marxism"): the mark-bearing 20-mark move is to name WHICH classical claim is revised and on what ground (the four-revision table), then close with the "relocation verdict" -- the tradition is refined, not refuted.
- **2023 Q3(a)** (historical materialism relevance) uses Gramsci's hegemony and Poulantzas's relative autonomy to REPAIR the economic-determinism objection.
- **Provenance discipline:** Lenin, Gramsci, Althusser, Miliband (1969), Poulantzas (1973) are cited by position/title and year only; no verbatim wording; no claim about any actual country or party.

MEMORY: On any "is Marxism still relevant" stem, deploy the four-revision table + the relocation verdict; on any "state and class" stem, run Miliband -> Poulantzas -> relative-autonomy-must-stay-relative.

EXAM APPLICATION 8 - Socialism: The Family, Its Varieties, and Gandhian Socialism

This subtopic owns the socialism-vs-communism and Gandhian-socialism stems.

- **2024 Q1(e)** ("Compare socialism and communism as two distinct political ideologies") is a compare stem: fix the axes (property, state, distribution, method) and run both down each, then adjudicate -- socialism is the family; communism is the Marxian classless higher phase. Do NOT write two sequential summaries.
- **2021 Q3(b)** ("distinctive features of Gandhian Socialism and its contemporary relevance") wants the trusteeship/decentralisation/self-rule (swarāj) cluster + the voluntary-conversion objection + a relevance verdict grounded in the means-ends identity.
- **Ownership caution:** the 2020 Q2(a) Gandhian-SOCIAL-DEVELOPMENT stem is owned by Development and Social Progress; keep Gandhian SOCIALISM here, route social development there.

MEMORY: Compare-socialism-communism = shared axes in parallel (property/state/ distribution/method). Gandhian socialism = trusteeship cluster + voluntary- conversion objection + means-ends verdict.

EXAM APPLICATION 9 - Inter-School Debates: Anarchism, Marxism, Democratic Socialism, Gandhi, M. N. Roy

These debates are the depth layer for the comparison and freedom stems.

- **2018 Q3(b)** ("Marxian Socialism and individual freedom") is strongest when it brings M. N. Roy's radical-humanist correction as the internal reply, alongside the §2.8 self-defeat conditional.
- **2021 Q3(a)** ("dispense with political authority completely?") is the anarchism-vs-Marxism state debate: Bakunin's new-elite fear vs the Marxist need for transitional organised power, ending in the unresolved verdict.
- Any "compare ideologies" or "Gandhi vs Marx" angle: use the matrix axes (domination / state / method / means-ends / fear) rather than back-to-back summaries.

MEMORY: Bring M. N. Roy to the freedom stem; run Bakunin-Marx on the state-abolition stem; always adjudicate the debate, never declare a knockout.

EXAM APPLICATION 10 - Criticisms, Replies and the Common Traps

This subtopic is the pre-submission checklist for every ideology answer.

- On any "critically evaluate / examine" stem (2025 Q2b Marxism; 2023 Q1b anarchism), the objection-reply-residual ladder IS the answer -- two objections, each fully worked, each ending in a residual, then a graded verdict.
- On "is X still relevant / is X viable" stems (2020 Q2b, 2019 Q3c), separate analytical survival from institutional record: what the doctrine still explains vs what its historical implementation forecloses.
- Close with a graded-verdict formula (diagnosis/remedy split; relocation verdict; necessary-not-sufficient; means-ends), never a flat yes/no.

MEMORY: Critically-examine = two objections, each with reply + residual, + graded verdict. Relevance = analytical survival vs institutional record. Never "prove" an ideology with a scheme or statute.

Workbook Source Audit

- Exact PYQ wording, year and marks: local Socio-Political Philosophy Paper II bank, 2018-2025.
- Exactly 13 owner questions (2018:2, 2019:2, 2020:2, 2021:2, 2022:0, 2023:2, 2024:2, 2025:1).
- Ownership discipline: the 2022 Marxian equity/equality 15-marker (Social and Political Ideals, hence no 2022 owned part here), the caste-specific Gandhi/Ambedkar stems (Caste), the 2020 Gandhian-social-development 20-marker (Development and Social Progress), the authority-tinged democracy stems (Sovereignty) and the 2018 liberal-democracy 10-marker (Forms of Government) are kept separate and not double-owned here.
- Model solutions authored at examiner grade: thesis -> doctrine in canonical terms -> named evidence unit (P1-P12) or Indian example -> objection/reply/residual -> graded verdict, each closing with a "Why this earns marks" note.
- MCQs: 40 core plus 8 remedial, exactly 48, strict A-B-C-D rotation 12 times.
- Original Mains: one solved 10-marker, one solved 15-marker and one solved 20-marker.
- Provenance discipline observed throughout: Lenin, Gramsci, Althusser, Miliband (1969) and Poulantzas (1973) by position/title and year only; Marx's 1844 Manuscripts, the 1848 Manifesto, the 1859 Preface and the 1875 Critique of the Gotha Programme by title and year only; the Directive Principles (Articles 38, 39, 43) are dated non-justiciable facts, not proof; no regime, party or period is characterised.
- Scaffolding discipline: the concept-of-ideology apparatus and the liberalism/conservatism comparison are marked context beyond the syllabus core (Anarchism; Marxism and Socialism).
- No current-affairs anchor is used (no verified 2026 development forced); relevance is static and syllabus-driven.
- Final consolidated register notes are intentionally excluded from this workbook.

Practice Design

The workbook sequence is the 13 exact verified PYQs -> 40 core MCQs -> 8 remedial MCQs -> original 10/15/20-mark Mains practice. There are no register notes and no canonical apparatus block in this workbook.

DIRECTIVE -> THESIS -> DOCTRINE -> NAMED EVIDENCE (P1-P12) / EXAMPLE -> OBJECTION / REPLY / RESIDUAL -> VERDICT

SOLVED PYQ BANK - EXACTLY 13 VERIFIED OWNER QUESTIONS

Exact wording, year and marks are parsed from the local Socio-Political Philosophy Paper II bank for 2018-2025. This clause owns exactly 13 primary parts (2018:2, 2019:2, 2020:2, 2021:2, 2022:0, 2023:2, 2024:2, 2025:1). Ownership discipline (explained, not silently double-owned): the 2022 Marxian equity-versus-equality 15-marker (Q2c) is owned by Social and Political Ideals, which is why this clause has no owned part in 2022; the 2019 Gandhi-versus-Ambedkar secular-democracy 20-marker (Q4a) and every caste-specific Gandhi/Ambedkar stem are owned by Caste; the 2020 Gandhian-social-development 20-marker (Q2a) is owned by Development and Social Progress; the Austin- and Kautilya-authority democracy stems are owned by Sovereignty; and the 2018 liberal-democracy 10-marker (Q1a) is owned by Forms of Government. None of those is counted here.

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q2(c), 15 marks

Question: Do you subscribe to the political ideology of Anarchists ? Justify your answer.

Model solution

Thesis. I subscribe to anarchism's CRITIQUE -- its refusal to identify order with sovereign command and its demand that coercive authority justify itself function by function -- but not to the strong CONSTRUCTIVE claim that a complex modern society can dispense with all public authority; the defensible position is philosophical, not insurrectionary, anarchism.

- **The doctrine, exactly.** Anarchism holds that coercive political authority, paradigmatically the sovereign state, lacks adequate moral justification, and that order can rest on voluntary association, mutual aid and federation. Its engine is the burden-of-justification argument: legitimate authority must respect autonomy and equality (1); the state claims a territorial monopoly of law and coercion (2); it demands obedience for a command's LEGALITY, not its rightness (3); that subordinates my judgment to another's institutional will (4); so the state bears a burden it cannot discharge (5).

- **Why I accept the critique (evidence P9).** Property and the state can function as an institutional power of appropriation and domination (Proudhon), and concentrated power deforms ruler and ruled (Bakunin), while cooperation and mutual aid are genuine sources of order (Kropotkin). Historical existence is not moral legitimacy.

- **Why I stop short (objection -> reply -> residual).** Objection: without public authority, scale, public goods and persistent aggressors go unaddressed. Reply: anarchism rejects DOMINATION, not coordination -- delegated, recallable, federated administration can operate across scales. Residual: the HIDDEN-AUTHORITY problem is unanswered -- expertise, status and economic power return after formal offices are abolished, so a society still needs accountable public power to check them.

Verdict (asymmetric). Anarchism's critique of unaccountable coercion is stronger than its account of the order that should replace the state; I subscribe to its standard -- that authority is legitimate only so far as it is justified, limited and accountable -- while holding that the standard is best met by constitutionalised public authority, not by its abolition.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it answers "do you subscribe?" with a graded yes/no (accept the critique via P9, reject the strong constructive claim via the hidden-authority residual) and closes on the asymmetric verdict, not a slogan.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2018 Q3(b), 15 marks

Question: Are Marxian Socialism and individual freedom consistent ? Discuss critically.

Model solution

Thesis. Marxian socialism and individual freedom are consistent ONLY CONDITIONALLY: they are consistent where collective ownership genuinely ENLARGES each person's real self-development and democratic control, and they become inconsistent -- the emancipatory claim defeating itself -- where "collective" power hardens into bureaucratic command.

- **Reframe "freedom".** Marx rejects a purely negative liberty (non-interference)

that leaves formal rights operating over radically unequal social conditions. His positive ideal is non-domination PLUS self-development: the capacity to engage in conscious, social, creative activity, of which alienated labour deprives the worker (evidence P3 -- estrangement from product, activity, species-being and others).

- **The consistency argument.** If the means of production are brought under genuinely social, democratic control, then the structural coercion of the wage-relation is removed and freedom is EXTENDED to those the market subordinated -- collective ownership is the condition, not the enemy, of real freedom.

- **The self-defeat condition (objection -> reply -> residual).** Objection (bureaucratic domination): state ownership can become ownership by officials, and a transitional "dictatorship of the proletariat" can entrench rather than wither (the strongest historical objection at §2.9). Reply (M. N. Roy's radical humanism): retain Marx's critique of exploitation but reject economic determinism and party absolutism and restore individual reason and ethical autonomy, since concentrated power cannot reliably serve emancipation. Residual: the historical record of transitional states remains adverse, so accountability, plural organisation and civil liberty must be built INTO the transition, not postponed.

Verdict (conditional). Marxian socialism and individual freedom are consistent as an IDEAL of collective self-development, and inconsistent in any form that subordinates the individual to class, party or historical necessity; the doctrine survives only if it constitutionalises the freedom it promises.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it turns "consistent?" into the "only if... otherwise self-defeats" conditional (P3 + §2.8), brings M. N. Roy as the internal Indian reply, concedes the adverse record, and grades rather than answers yes/no.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2019 Q1(c), 10 marks

Question: Evaluate Mahatma Gandhi as a political anarchist.

Model solution

Thesis. Gandhi is a QUALIFIED political anarchist: a moral and decentralist anarchist in IDEAL, but a pragmatic reformer in political METHOD -- so he shares anarchism's suspicion of the centralised coercive state without sharing its insurrectionary anti-theism or class war.

- **The anarchist affinity.** Gandhi's self-rule (*swarāj*) begins with rule over oneself; political freedom is insecure without mastery of desire, non-violence and local self-government. His preference for decentralised village republics and a state reduced to a minimum places him squarely within the anarchist family's rejection of concentrated coercive authority.

- **Where he diverges (evidence P10).** His non-violence, trusteeship, religious ethics and constructive programme REPLACE class war and anti-theism; means must prefigure ends, so a violent, centralising path cannot produce a non-violent, decentralised order. This is a moral anarchism of transformation, not a Bakuninite programme of abolition.

- **The critical qualification.** Gandhi does not call for insurrection against the state; he accepts a minimal state and works through mass civil action and constructive reform. So his anarchism is an ideal-limit, approached by moral and institutional transformation, not a demand to abolish authority now.

Verdict. Evaluated as a political anarchist, Gandhi qualifies in aspiration -- decentralised self-rule/*swarāj*, minimal state, distrust of coercive centralism -- but not in method, since he pursues the ideal through non-violence and reform rather than the abolition of the state; "anarchist in ideal, reformer in method" is the exact formula.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it grades the label (affinity via self-rule/*swarāj*/minimal state; divergence via P10 means-ends and non-violence) and lands the precise "ideal vs method" verdict instead of a flat yes or no.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2019 Q3(c), 15 marks

Question: What do you consider to be the future of Marxism in the context of the prevalent free-market economy?

Model solution

Thesis. In a prevailing free-market economy the FUTURE of Marxism lies in its survival as a diagnostic and critical framework, not as an infallible prediction of collapse or a blueprint for a command economy: what persists is the analysis; what fails is the timetable and the party-state remedy.

- **What the free market vindicates in Marx.** Concentration of capital, commodification, precarity, recurrent crises and the ideological normalisation of market relations remain live phenomena the analysis still explains (evidence P2 -- the contradiction between developing forces and existing relations; P4 -- structural exploitation through surplus value, argued as a relation, not via the contested price theory).

- **What the free market falsifies.** Revolution did not first triumph in the most advanced economies; welfare compromise, universal franchise and political organisation altered the trajectory. Marxism is an explanatory framework, not an infallible schedule -- and the neo-Marxist turn already absorbed this: causal weight was RELOCATED into ideology and the state (P6 Gramsci's hegemony; P8 Poulantzas's relatively autonomous state) rather than the doctrine abandoned.

- **Objection -> reply -> residual.** Objection: the collapse of command economies refutes Marxism. Reply: it refutes the unaccountable party-state, not the critique of exploitation; the two must be separated. Residual: Marxism supplies no internal safeguard against the transitional state entrenching itself -- that gap is why its political future depends on democratic and constitutional reconstruction.

Verdict (relocation). The future of Marxism under free markets is as a REFINED critical tradition: its diagnosis of concentration, precarity and ideological reproduction retains force; its predictive schedule and command-economy remedy do not; so it will endure as analysis and critique rather than as a governing programme -- with no verdict passed here on any particular country.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it splits diagnosis (P2/P4, still explains) from prediction and remedy (falsified), uses the neo-Marxist relocation (P6/P8) as the survival mechanism, and grades without commenting on any actual regime.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2020 Q1(e), 10 marks

Question: Do you think that the prevailing pandemic will lead to anarchism in society? Discuss.

Model solution

Thesis. No -- a pandemic does not "lead to anarchism", because anarchism is not the breakdown of order but a normative doctrine of order WITHOUT sovereign coercion; a crisis may produce temporary ANARCHY (disorder) or, revealingly, a surge of voluntary MUTUAL AID, but neither amounts to the considered political ideology.

- **The decisive distinction.** Anarchy is the absence or collapse of effective rule and may mean disorder; anarchism is a critique of domination that PROPOSES non-coercive order through association, mutual aid and federation. Conflating the two is the exact trap the stem sets.

- **What a pandemic actually shows (evidence P9, used carefully).** Emergencies simultaneously (a) expand STATE authority (public-health coercion, mobilisation) and (b) reveal dense VOLUNTARY cooperation -- neighbourhood networks, community kitchens, mutual-aid groups -- which illustrate Kropotkin's claim that mutual aid is a genuine source of social order, not an accidental exception. But such networks show limited, local capacities; they do not prove a complex society can eliminate public authority.

- **Objection -> reply.** Objection: crisis distrust of the state could snowball into anti-statism. Reply: distrust of a particular government is not the principled anarchist rejection of the state as such; and pandemics typically strengthen demands FOR competent public authority, not for its abolition.

Verdict. A pandemic may generate episodes of anarchy and impressive mutual aid, but it does not generate anarchISM; if anything it displays BOTH the indispensability of accountable public authority AND the real, bounded power of voluntary cooperation -- which is the anarchist insight without the anarchist conclusion.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it refuses the anarchy/anarchism conflation up front, reads the pandemic through P9 (mutual aid, bounded), and grades to "shows the insight, not the conclusion" rather than answering a careless yes.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2020 Q2(b), 15 marks

Question: How far is Marxism as a philosophical doctrine relevant in the present context? Justify your answer.

Model solution

Thesis. Marxism as a PHILOSOPHICAL doctrine remains substantially relevant -- as a method, a critique and a theory of ideology -- even where its 19th-century predictions and 20th-century political implementations have failed; relevance must be judged by diagnostic power, not by the fate of any regime.

- **The philosophical core that survives.** Historical materialism reads social formations through productive forces, relations of production and class (evidence P2); the theory of alienation diagnoses the estrangement of labour under commodified production (P3); the critique of ideology explains how contingent, class-bound relations come to appear natural and inevitable (and Gramsci's hegemony, P6, and Althusser's interpellation, P7, extend this into culture and subject-formation). These are analytical instruments, not dated slogans.

- **Where it needs correction.** Economic reductionism is a real tendency: caste, religion, gender and nationalism have relative autonomy and cannot be derived from class alone -- so class analysis is NECESSARY BUT INSUFFICIENT, especially in India (§2.9). The reply treats these as materially embedded powers rather than mere epiphenomena, expanding the analysis through hegemony and social reproduction.

- **Objection -> reply -> residual.** Objection: authoritarian outcomes discredit the doctrine. Reply: separate the critique of exploitation from the unaccountable transitional state; the philosophy is not the regime. Residual: the doctrine offers no internal safeguard against that state -- the strongest standing objection.

Verdict (diagnosis/remedy split). The philosophical analysis of concentration, exploitation and ideological reproduction retains force; the institutional remedy -- an unaccountable transitional state -- does not, and the theory supplies no internal guard against it. Marxism is therefore relevant as critique and method, refined rather than refuted.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it isolates the philosophical core (P2/P3/P6/P7), concedes the necessary-not-sufficient limit and the authoritarian residual, and closes on the diagnosis/remedy split rather than a yes/no on "relevance".

Solved PYQ 7 - 2021 Q3(a), 20 marks

Question: Discuss anarchism as a political ideology. Is it possible to dispense with political authority completely? Give reasons for your answer.

Model solution

Thesis. Anarchism is a coherent political ideology built on a single powerful argument -- that coercive authority must justify itself and cannot -- but it is NOT possible to dispense with political authority COMPLETELY in a complex society; the tenable conclusion is the abolition of unaccountable DOMINATION, not of all public coordination.

- **Anarchism as an ideology (the argument).** It diagnoses domination as flowing from coercive hierarchy itself and prescribes voluntary association, mutual aid and federation. The burden-of-justification argument runs in five steps (autonomy/equality -> the state's territorial coercion monopoly -> obedience demanded for legality not rightness -> subordination of judgment -> unmet burden). Its strands differ on property and transition: mutualism (Proudhon), collectivist (Bakunin), anarcho-communism (Kropotkin), individualist and philosophical anarchism, which denies an automatic duty to obey without demanding insurrection.

- **The strongest case for dispensing with authority (evidence P9).** The state has historically organised war, repression and structural domination; federated, delegated and recallable administration can coordinate without a sovereign centre; so much "necessary" authority is really entrenched power.

- **Why complete dispensal fails (objection -> reply -> residual).** Objections: the security dilemma (private violence, persistent aggressors), scale and public goods, and above all HIDDEN AUTHORITY -- expertise, status and economic power return once formal offices vanish. Replies neutralise the first two (coordination is not domination). Residual: the hidden-authority problem is unanswered, and it requires accountable PUBLIC authority to police domination inside voluntary associations. Bakunin's own warning -- that a revolutionary state breeds a new elite -- cuts BOTH ways: unaccountable power returns whether it is called a state or not.

Verdict (asymmetric). Anarchism succeeds as a CRITERION -- authority is legitimate only so far as it is justified, limited, decentralised and accountable -- and fails as a total programme; we cannot dispense with political authority completely, but we can, and should, subject it relentlessly to that anarchist test.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it expounds anarchism as an argument with named strands, presses the strongest case (P9), then answers "completely?" through the hidden-authority residual and Bakunin's double-edged warning, closing on the asymmetric criterion verdict.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2021 Q3(b), 15 marks

Question: Discuss the distinctive features of Gandhian Socialism and its contemporary relevance.

Model solution

Thesis. Gandhian socialism is a distinctive NON-VIOLENT, DECENTRALIST socialism that seeks equality and freedom from exploitation without class war or centralised industrial collectivism; its contemporary relevance lies in its ethics of means-ends unity and ecological restraint, even as its central mechanism -- trusteeship -- remains institutionally fragile.

- **Distinctive features.** It combines non-possession, TRUSTEESHIP, bread labour, decentralised production, village self-rule (swarāj) and SARVODAYA (the welfare of all). Its argument: property carries a social obligation; production should meet need without degrading labour, community or nature; and the means must embody the non-violent end (evidence P10 -- means determine ends). It rejects BOTH unrestricted capitalism AND violent, centralised collectivism.

- **How it differs from Marxian socialism.** Where Marx locates the root in class exploitation and prescribes revolutionary transition, Gandhi locates it in greed, violence and modern industrial civilisation and prescribes moral transformation, trusteeship and constructive work; self-rule begins with ethical self-restraint, not seizure of the means of production.

- **Objection -> reply -> residual.** Objection: trusteeship depends on the voluntary moral conversion of owners and may simply preserve unequal ownership. Reply: Gandhi treats trusteeship as a non-violent DIRECTION of transition, not a celebration of possession. Residual: without enforceable institutions the objection stands -- Ambedkar's warning against relying on the conscience of the dominant is decisive, and Gandhian socialism needs institutional backing to be more than exhortation.

- **Contemporary relevance.** Its emphasis on decentralisation, need-based production, dignity of labour and non-violent means speaks directly to ecological limits, over-consumption and the alienation of scale -- a live corrective to productivism.

Verdict. Gandhian socialism is distinctive precisely in fusing equality with non-violence and decentralisation; it is contemporarily relevant as an ETHICAL and ecological critique, but delivers on that promise only when trusteeship is underwritten by enforceable institutions rather than left to conscience.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it names the trusteeship/self-rule (swarāj)/sarvodaya cluster, contrasts it with Marxian socialism, presses the voluntary-conversion objection to a residual (Ambedkar), and grounds relevance in means-ends + ecology.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2023 Q1(b), 10 marks

Question: Critically examine the anarchist's view that "all States always and everywhere are illegitimate and unjust."

Model solution

Thesis. The anarchist claim that "all States always and everywhere are illegitimate and unjust" states the doctrine at its strongest and most UNIVERSAL -- and that universality is also its weakness: the burden-of-justification argument shows the state must always JUSTIFY itself, but not that every state everywhere maximally FAILS to; the defensible core is philosophical anarchism, not this absolute.

- **Reconstruct the claim.** It rests on the five-step argument: legitimate authority must respect autonomy and equality; the state claims a territorial monopoly of coercion; it demands obedience for legality, not rightness; this subordinates individual judgment; therefore the state bears an unmet burden of justification (evidence P9 -- property/authority as institutionalised domination; Bakunin's thesis that concentrated power corrupts).

- **Why the UNIVERSAL form overreaches.** "Always and everywhere" collapses the distinction between a standing DUTY TO JUSTIFY and a verdict of GUILT. A liberal constitutional state that limits itself by rights, consent, accountability and the rule of law satisfies far more of the justification burden than an absolutist one -- so states differ in legitimacy by degree; a blanket "all... always" ignores that gradient.

- **The disciplined reply (philosophical anarchism).** The strongest anarchism is PHILOSOPHICAL: it denies an AUTOMATIC duty to obey the state simply because a command is legal, while allowing critical allegiance to institutions that earn it. That preserves the moral insight (no unearned authority) without the false empirical claim that every state is equally unjust.

Verdict (criterion). Judged by the justification of coercion, the anarchist is right that NO state is self-legitimizing and every state must answer for its coercion; but "all, always, everywhere, illegitimate" is too strong -- legitimacy is a graded achievement, and the tenable position is that authority is presumptively suspect until justified, not that it is universally condemned.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it "critically examines" by reconstructing the claim via P9, isolating the fatal word "always/everywhere", and rescuing the defensible philosophical-anarchist core with a graded criterion verdict.

Solved PYQ 10 - 2023 Q3(a), 20 marks

Question: Explain Historical Materialism and discuss its relevance in the context of social development and change.

Model solution

Thesis. Historical materialism explains social formations through the interaction of productive forces, relations of production, class structure and political-ideological institutions; it remains highly relevant to social development and change AS A METHOD, provided its base-superstructure relation is read non-mechanically and supplemented where class alone is insufficient.

- **The doctrine as a causal chain (evidence P2).** (1) Human beings must produce the means of life; (2) production occurs through definite social relations; (3) productive forces develop within those relations; (4) existing relations eventually become FETTERS on further development; (5) the conflict between forces and relations becomes social and political struggle; (6) a new mode of production can emerge through that struggle. The elements: productive forces (capacity), relations of production (ownership/control), mode of production (their unity), base/superstructure (a relation, NOT a one-way switch) and class struggle (the motor of transformation).

- **Relevance to social development and change.** It supplies a materialist account of WHY social orders change -- technological and productive development destabilising inherited property relations -- and of how law, politics and ideology are anchored in social labour and power. Extended by Gramsci's hegemony (P6) and Althusser's reproduction (P7), it explains not only revolution but the STABILITY of orders through consent and subject-formation.

- **Objection -> reply -> residual.** Objection: economic determinism -- caste, religion, gender and nationalism cannot be read off the base. Reply: historical materialism can treat these as materially embedded powers with relative autonomy, not epiphenomena. Residual: in India especially, class analysis is NECESSARY BUT INSUFFICIENT -- caste operates through status, endogamy and social reproduction that class alone cannot derive; say this before the objection is put.

Verdict (necessary-not-sufficient). As a research programme, historical materialism remains a powerful explanation of social development and change; its limit is reductionism, repaired by reading the base-superstructure relation reciprocally and adding the independent mechanisms of caste, gender and culture -- so it is refined, not refuted.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it runs P2 as six numbered premises (not slogans), states the base/superstructure caution pre-emptively, extends via P6/P7, and grades with the necessary-not-sufficient verdict tuned to Indian social change.

Solved PYQ 11 - 2024 Q1(d), 10 marks

Question: Present an exposition of the concept of alienation as propounded by Marx.

Model solution

Thesis. For Marx, ALIENATION is the estrangement of the worker from their own productive life under conditions of private property and the division of labour -- a structural condition of capitalist production, broader than low pay, in which labour that should be self-realising becomes an external, compelled and dispossessed activity.

- **The four dimensions (evidence P3, from the 1844 Manuscripts).** The worker is estranged (1) FROM THE PRODUCT, which confronts them as another's property; (2) FROM THE ACTIVITY of labour, which is externally compelled rather than self-realising; (3) FROM SPECIES-BEING, as conscious creative activity is reduced to a means of survival; and (4) FROM OTHER PERSONS, as workers compete and social relations assume commodity form.

- **The mark-bearing distinction.** Alienation is BROADER THAN LOW WAGES: a well-paid worker can remain alienated where labour, product and purpose are controlled by others. So the remedy is not merely higher pay but restored control over the activity and ends of work -- which is why alienation, not just inequality, is central to Marx's critique.

- **Objection -> reply.** Objection: species-being assumes a controversial universal human essence. Reply: it can be reconstructed MINIMALLY -- persons require meaningful agency, social recognition and control over their central activities -- without positing a fixed metaphysical essence.

Verdict. Alienation names a genuine and enduring feature of commodified, hierarchically controlled work; its diagnostic reach extends well beyond the 19th-century factory to contemporary labour wherever activity, product and purpose are severed from the producer -- which is why it remains Marx's most portable concept.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- as an EXPOSITION it leads with the definition and the four dimensions (P3), makes the "broader than low wages" distinction the centrepiece, adds only one controlled objection/reply, and keeps exposition dominant as the directive demands.

Solved PYQ 12 - 2024 Q1(e), 10 marks

Question: Compare socialism and communism as two distinct political ideologies.

Model solution

Thesis. Socialism and communism are distinct ideologies, not synonyms: SOCIALISM names a broad family that subjects productive property to social control by many possible routes, while COMMUNISM (in Marxist vocabulary) names a specific END-STATE -- a classless, stateless order distributing according to need -- reached through a transition; the difference is one of scope, ownership regime, the fate of the state and the principle of distribution.

- **Run the shared axes in parallel (evidence P11).**

- **PROPERTY:** socialism = social control in varied forms (state, cooperative, market, moral); communism = common ownership with classes abolished.

- **STATE:** socialism may retain a democratic, active state; communism expects the political state, as an instrument of class domination, to lose its class function.

- **DISTRIBUTION:** socialism = by contribution, need or a mix; communism (higher phase) = according to need, once the "bourgeois" measure of contribution is transcended (evidence P12 -- equity is not equality; the lower phase still pays by contribution).

- **METHOD:** socialism = revolutionary OR gradual/parliamentary; communism = reached through the transitional phase Marx calls the dictatorship of the proletariat.

- **The vocabulary caution.** In Marxist usage "socialism" often denotes the transitional LOWER PHASE on the way to communism; in wider political theory it names the whole family. State which sense you are using, or the comparison collapses.

Verdict. They are distinct: communism is a specific classless, stateless, need-based end-state within the Marxist tradition, whereas socialism is the broader family of doctrines that socialise economic power by diverse routes and need not abolish the state at all -- so all communists are socialists, but not all socialists are communists.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it COMPARES on fixed axes (property/state/ distribution/method) via P11 and P12 rather than writing two summaries, flags the lower-phase/higher-phase vocabulary, and lands the "all communists are socialists, not vice versa" verdict.

Solved PYQ 13 - 2025 Q2(b), 15 marks

Question: Evaluate Marxism as a Political Ideology.

Model solution

Thesis. Evaluated as a political ideology, Marxism is exceptionally strong as a METHOD, a CRITIQUE and a theory of IDEOLOGY, and correspondingly weak as a PREDICTION and as an institutional programme; its enduring value is diagnostic, its recurring failure political -- and a fair evaluation must keep the two apart.

- **What Marxism is.** Simultaneously a method (dialectical-historical analysis), a critique (exploitation, alienation, commodity relations, ideology), a theory of change (contradiction and class struggle) and a political project (collective emancipation). As ideology in the DESCRIPTIVE sense it guides action; in the PEJORATIVE sense it is itself the theory that UNMASKS ideology as the naturalising of class-bound relations.

- **Strengths (evidence).** Historical materialism explains structural change (P2); surplus value shows exploitation as a RELATION, not unfair bargaining, so it survives even where the labour theory of value is contested (P4); the critique of ideology, extended by Gramsci's hegemony (P6) and Althusser's interpellation (P7), explains how orders secure consent.

- **Objections, each with reply and residual (§2.9).** (1) Economic determinism -> treat caste/gender/culture as materially embedded, relatively autonomous powers -> residual: class is necessary but insufficient, sharply so in India. (2) Failed prediction (revolution not in advanced economies) -> Lenin's weakest-link and vanguard revision (P5) -> residual: the vanguard has no mechanism subordinating party to class (substitutionism). (3) Authoritarian outcome -> build liberty and accountability into the transition -> residual: the historical record stays adverse and the theory offers no internal safeguard. (4) Class reductionism -> anti-caste and feminist analyses identify distinct mechanisms.

- **The neo-Marxist relocation.** Later Marxism keeps the materialist mechanism but relocates causal weight into party, culture and state form (P8 -- the relatively autonomous state) -- refinement, not abandonment.

Verdict (diagnosis/remedy split). Marxism's analysis of concentration, exploitation and ideological reproduction retains force; its institutional remedy -- an unaccountable transitional state -- does not, and it supplies no internal guard against that outcome. As an ideology it is therefore best judged a powerful CRITIQUE in permanent search of a safe political form.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it evaluates on BOTH senses of ideology, banks the strengths (P2/P4/P6/P7), runs all four §2.9 objections to residuals with the P5 revision, adds the P8 relocation, and closes on the diagnosis/remedy split, not a verdict on any regime.

Three original questions authored for this package (not PYQs), one each at 10, 15 and 20 marks, with full model solutions.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains 1

Original practice - Socio-Political Philosophy Paper II - 10 marks - answer in about 150 words - directive: Bring out / Assess

Question: Bring out the difference between the descriptive and the pejorative (Marxian) senses of 'ideology'. Is the 'end of ideology' thesis tenable?

Model solution

Thesis. 'Ideology' carries two senses, and the 'end of ideology' claim collapses under both.

Doctrine. In the *descriptive* (neutral) sense an ideology is any organised belief-system that diagnoses a social ill, pictures a good order and guides action -- liberalism, socialism and anarchism all qualify. In the *pejorative/Marxian* sense (canonical 2.6), ideology is a socially rooted framework that makes historically specific, class-bound relations appear natural, universal or inevitable; it is 'not merely a lie' but a naturalisation of contingency.

Evidence. Marx's claim that the ruling ideas are the ideas of the ruling class expresses the pejorative sense; the neutral sense is what political science uses when it classifies party doctrines.

Assessment. The 'end of ideology' thesis is empirically weak: anarchist, Marxist, nationalist and ecological mobilisation persists, and announcing ideology's death is itself an ideological move that naturalises the status quo.

Verdict. Distinguish the senses first; the thesis fails on its own terms.

MEMORY: Two senses (neutral vs naturalising) + persistence of mobilisation + 'end of ideology is itself ideological' = full marks.

Original Mains 2

Original practice - Socio-Political Philosophy Paper II - 15 marks - answer in about 250 words - directive: Critically examine

Question: 'Nationalisation is not the same as socialisation.' Critically examine with reference to the socialist tradition.

Model solution

Thesis. Socialism demands control by *society*; nationalisation is only one, potentially self-defeating, route to it.

Doctrine. Socialism is a family of doctrines subjecting productive property to social control for equality, cooperation and welfare (canonical 3.1). Its core is *socialisation* -- democratic, participatory, accountable control -- not merely transferring title to the state. The canonical warning (3.4, evidence-unit P11) is explicit: socialism is not identical with state ownership, and nationalisation without democratic control can become ownership by officials, i.e. bureaucratic domination.

Evidence and distinctions. The family separates on the axes property/state/distribution/method: utopian vs scientific (Marx), Fabian gradualism, guild and market socialism, and Gandhian trusteeship. Communism (Marxian higher phase) abolishes classes and distributes by need; social democracy regulates capitalism through tax-transfer. Across these, the constant is *control by society*, not the legal form of ownership.

Objection and reply. A defender of nationalisation replies that public ownership is a necessary lever against private domination. Reply: necessary perhaps, but insufficient -- if the enterprise is run by an unaccountable bureaucracy, private domination is merely replaced by official domination, and the emancipatory claim is defeated (the socialist self-defeat condition).

Residual. How to institutionalise genuine democratic control at scale remains contested (incentives, information, accountability).

Verdict. The statement is largely correct: nationalisation is a means that becomes socialism only when it delivers accountable social control.

MEMORY: socialisation = control by society; nationalisation without democracy = bureaucratic domination (P11). State the axes, then the self-defeat condition.

Original Mains 3

Original practice - Socio-Political Philosophy Paper II - 20 marks - answer in about 300 words - directive: Critically examine and assess

Question: Anarchism and Marxism both seek to end domination, yet they divide sharply on the state. Critically examine their disagreement and assess whose diagnosis is the more defensible.

Model solution

Thesis. Anarchism and Marxism share the enemy -- domination rooted in capitalism -- but split on the *state as method*; each diagnosis illuminates what the other obscures, so the defensible verdict is conditional rather than a knock-out.

Common ground. Both reject the existing order as systematically dominating and both project a stateless, classless end. Marxism's classless-stateless communism and anarchism's federated society converge on the goal.

The disagreement. Anarchism (evidence-unit P9: Proudhon on property-as-appropriation, Bakunin's corruption thesis, Kropotkin's mutual aid) holds that the state is intrinsically dominating: obedience is owed to legality, not rightness, so no transitional sovereign is legitimate; abolition must be immediate and coordination achieved by federation. Marxism (P1 state as the executive of class relations; P5 Lenin on the weakest link and the vanguard) holds that the state is a *class* instrument that must be captured and used transitionally -- the dictatorship of the proletariat -- before it 'withers'.

The decisive exchange. Bakunin predicts that a revolutionary workers' state will breed a new ruling stratum; the historical record of transitional states is an adverse residual Marxists must concede. Marxists reply that entrenched property cannot be dissolved without organised political power, and that immediate abolition invites either reconquest by the old order or the return of *hidden authority* (expertise, informal status, economic power) -- anarchism's own strongest internal objection.

Assessment. Anarchism's diagnosis is sharper about the *dangers of concentrated power*; Marxism's is sharper about the *structural tenacity of property*. Neither refutes the other outright: the anarchist critique of transitional power is vindicated by history, while the Marxist critique of premature abolition is vindicated by the persistence of domination without an organising counter-power.

Verdict. On the narrow question 'can we dispense with authority at once?', Marxism is the more defensible; on 'is transitional state power self-limiting?', anarchism's caution is vindicated.

MEMORY: shared enemy + state-as-method split; P9/Bakunin vs P1/P5/Lenin; hidden-authority objection both ways; conditional verdict, not a knock-out.

Answer-specific execution and compression upgrades

These controls follow the detailed models and make each one executable in the timed paper.

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q2(c), 15 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **the stated directive**. Address this exact question: *Do you subscribe to the political ideology of Anarchists ? Justify your answer.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Do you subscribe to the political ideology of Anarchists ? Justify your answer.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2018 Q3(b), 15 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **the stated directive**. Address this exact question: *Are Marxian Socialism and individual freedom consistent ? Discuss critically.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Are Marxian Socialism and individual freedom consistent ? Discuss critically.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2019 Q1(c), 10 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **Evaluate**. Address this exact question: *Evaluate Mahatma Gandhi as a political anarchist.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Evaluate Mahatma Gandhi as a political anarchist.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 150 words: verdict-led definition, three analytical moves, one precise qualification and a direct close. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2019 Q3(c), 15 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **What**. Address this exact question: *What do you consider to be the future of Marxism in the context of the prevalent free-market economy?* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *What do you consider to be the future of Marxism in the context of the prevalent free-market economy?* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2020 Q1(e), 10 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **the stated directive**. Address this exact question: *Do you think that the prevailing pandemic will lead to anarchism in society? Discuss.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Do you think that the prevailing pandemic will lead to anarchism in society? Discuss.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 150 words: verdict-led definition, three analytical moves, one precise qualification and a direct close. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2020 Q2(b), 15 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **How**. Address this exact question: *How far is Marxism as a philosophical doctrine relevant in the present context? Justify your answer.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *How far is Marxism as a philosophical doctrine relevant in the present context? Justify your answer.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2021 Q3(a), 20 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **Discuss**. Address this exact question: *Discuss anarchism as a political ideology. Is it possible to dispense with political authority completely? Give reasons for your answer.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Discuss anarchism as a political ideology. Is it possible to dispense with political authority completely? Give reasons for your answer.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: about 300 words: thesis, six developed moves, named comparison, strongest objection/reply, India-linked application where relevant and a graded conclusion. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2021 Q3(b), 15 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **Discuss**. Address this exact question: *Discuss the distinctive features of Gandhian Socialism and its contemporary relevance.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Discuss the distinctive features of Gandhian Socialism and its contemporary relevance.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2023 Q1(b), 10 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **Critically examine**. Address this exact question: *Critically examine the anarchist's view that "all States always and everywhere are illegitimate and unjust."* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Critically examine the anarchist's view that "all States always and everywhere are illegitimate and unjust."* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 150 words: verdict-led definition, three analytical moves, one precise qualification and a direct close. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 10 - 2023 Q3(a), 20 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **Explain**. Address this exact question: *Explain Historical Materialism and discuss its relevance in the context of social development and change*. Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Explain Historical Materialism and discuss its relevance in the context of social development and change*. rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: about 300 words: thesis, six developed moves, named comparison, strongest objection/reply, India-linked application where relevant and a graded conclusion. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 11 - 2024 Q1(d), 10 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **Present**. Address this exact question: *Present an exposition of the concept of alienation as propounded by Marx*. Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Present an exposition of the concept of alienation as propounded by Marx*. rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 150 words: verdict-led definition, three analytical moves, one precise qualification and a direct close. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 12 - 2024 Q1(e), 10 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **the stated directive**. Address this exact question: *Compare socialism and communism as two distinct political ideologies*. Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Compare socialism and communism as two distinct political ideologies*. rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 150 words: verdict-led definition, three analytical moves, one precise qualification and a direct close. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Solved PYQ 13 - 2025 Q2(b), 15 marks - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **Evaluate**. Address this exact question: *Evaluate Marxism as a Political Ideology*. Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Evaluate Marxism as a Political Ideology*. rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Original Mains 1 - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **Bring out**. Address this exact question: *Bring out the difference between the descriptive and the pejorative (Marxian) senses of 'ideology'. Is the 'end of ideology' thesis tenable?* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Bring out the difference between the descriptive and the pejorative (Marxian) senses of 'ideology'. Is the 'end of ideology' thesis tenable?* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Original Mains 2 - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **the stated directive**. Address this exact question: *'Nationalisation is not the same as socialisation.' Critically examine with reference to the socialist tradition*. Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *'Nationalisation is not the same as socialisation.' Critically examine with reference to the socialist tradition*. rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

Original Mains 3 - timed-paper upgrade

Directive and demand decoding: The operative demand is **the stated directive**. Address this exact question: *Anarchism and Marxism both seek to end domination, yet they divide sharply on the state. Critically examine their disagreement and assess whose diagnosis is the more defensible.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

How to improve this answer: State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Anarchism and Marxism both seek to end domination, yet they divide sharply on the state. Critically examine their disagreement and assess whose diagnosis is the more defensible.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

Executable exam-length/compression guidance: 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.